



BRIEFING FOR LANDLORDS & OWNER-OCCUPIERS

Break up with gas — and get ahead of the 2030 rules

What the Hestora thermal energy store means for landlords facing EPC C by 2030, and for owner-occupiers who want lower, steadier bills without rebuilding their home.

Hestora Limited · August 2026 · www.hestora.net

1. The rules are changing — especially for landlords

Government has confirmed that all privately rented homes in England and Wales must reach **EPC C or equivalent by 2030**. The new regime is dual-metric: every property needs a band C on fabric performance, plus a band C on either its heating system or its smart readiness. Critically, no property relying on a fossil-fuel boiler can score band C on the heating-system metric — a gas boiler caps that route at band D. Landlords can spend up to a £10,000-per-property cost cap, qualifying expenditure counts from October 2025, and maximum penalties rise to £30,000 per property per breach. Homes brought to standard before October 2029 are grandparented for up to ten years.

For owner-occupiers there is no compliance deadline — but the same direction of travel: new HEM-based EPCs from October 2026, a gas-boiler phase-out underway, and heating costs that swing with every winter energy crisis. Acting early is cheaper than acting under pressure.

2. What Hestora is

Hestora is a thermal energy store designed to replace your boiler. It is a 40 kWh pressurised, water-based store that fills up on cheap off-peak electricity overnight — about 7p/kWh on widely available smart tariffs from Octopus, E.ON, EDF and others — then heats your home and hot water all day, through the radiators and pipework you already have. It occupies the space of a hot-water cylinder — 650 mm x 650 mm and 1,800 mm tall — and because it arrives light and is filled with water on site, it can be installed anywhere in the home: garage, utility room, airing cupboard or loft. Installed in around a day. No outdoor unit. No new radiators. No fabric upgrade required first.



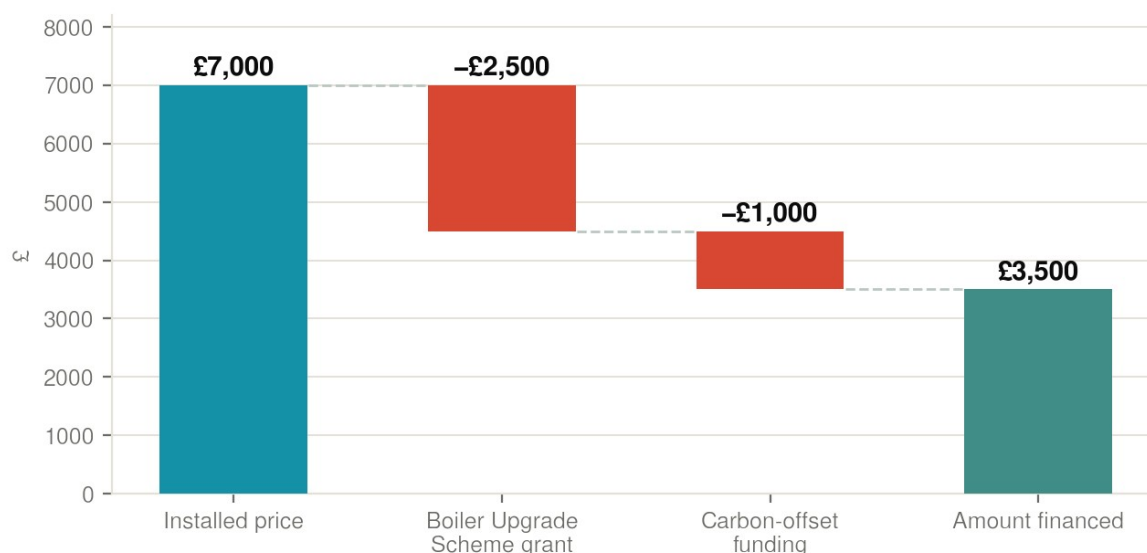
Hestora in a standard utility room — the space a hot-water cylinder occupies today. It can equally go in the garage, airing cupboard or loft.

- **Boiler-like experience** — mains-pressure hot water and the same high flow temperatures your radiators expect. Tenants and family notice nothing except the bill.
- **Independently certified** — the pressure vessel is certified to PD 5500:2024+A2 (Category 2) and tested by British Engineering Services to 17.86 bar, more than double its operating pressure.
- **Built to last** — >30-year design life: water, steel and insulation, with no refrigerants and no battery cells to degrade or replace on a 10-15-year cycle.
- **Hands-off smart charging** — the control system automatically finds the cheapest, greenest overnight window. Nothing to programme, nothing to remember.

3. What it costs — and what the grants do

The installed price is £7,000 — below the typical installed cost of an air-source heat pump. Two funding streams are expected to cut that roughly in half: the £2,500 Boiler Upgrade Scheme grant and approximately £1,000 of carbon-offset funding. BUS access for thermal energy stores depends on the BSI standard being defined, alongside MCS certification and testing by BRE — like the rest of our category, we are waiting for these to be confirmed, and we will keep everyone who registers updated.

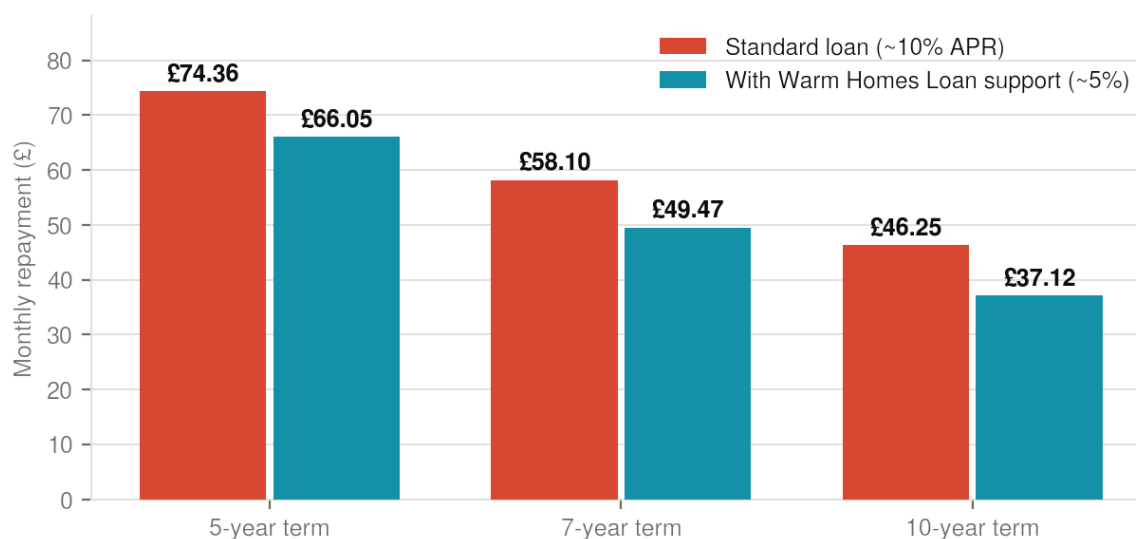
From list price to financed balance — the customer cost stack



The customer cost stack: £7,000 installed, less the £2,500 Boiler Upgrade Scheme grant and ~£1,000 of carbon-offset funding, leaves £3,500 to finance. Both reductions are contingent on the BSI thermal storage standard, MCS certification and BRE testing — the expected position at commercial launch.

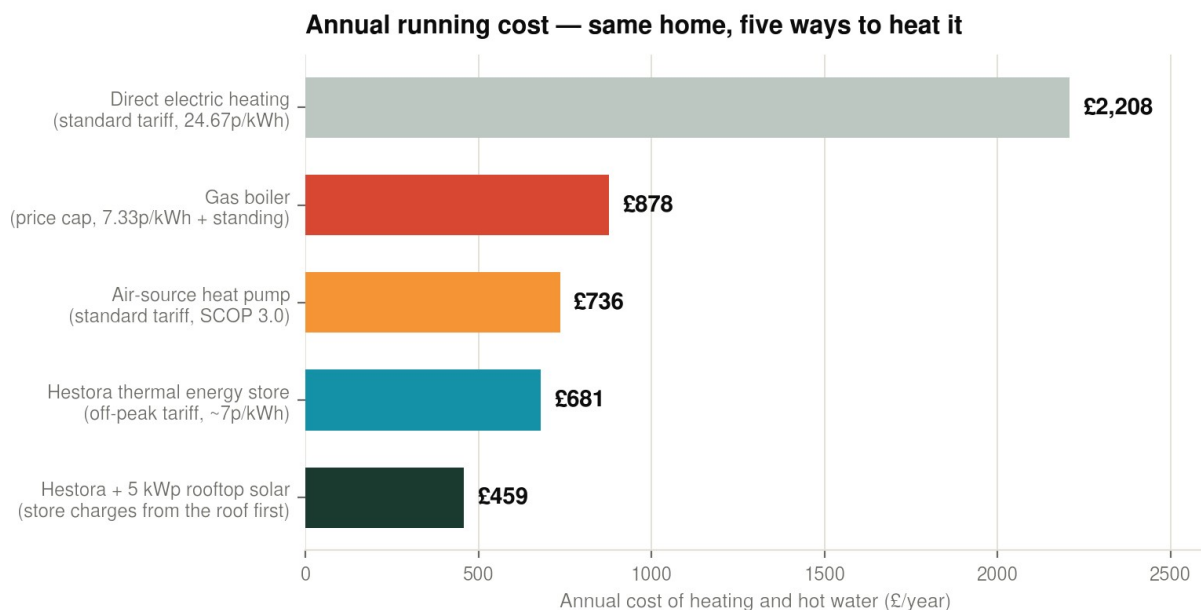
That £3,500 balance is where the government's Warm Homes Loan Scheme comes in. WHLS pays lenders a grant to cut the borrower's interest rate by around 5 percentage points on green home improvements — and it is open to both owner-occupiers and private landlords. Our modelling of the scheme rules shows what the monthly numbers look like:

Financing the £3,500 balance — monthly repayments with and without WHLS



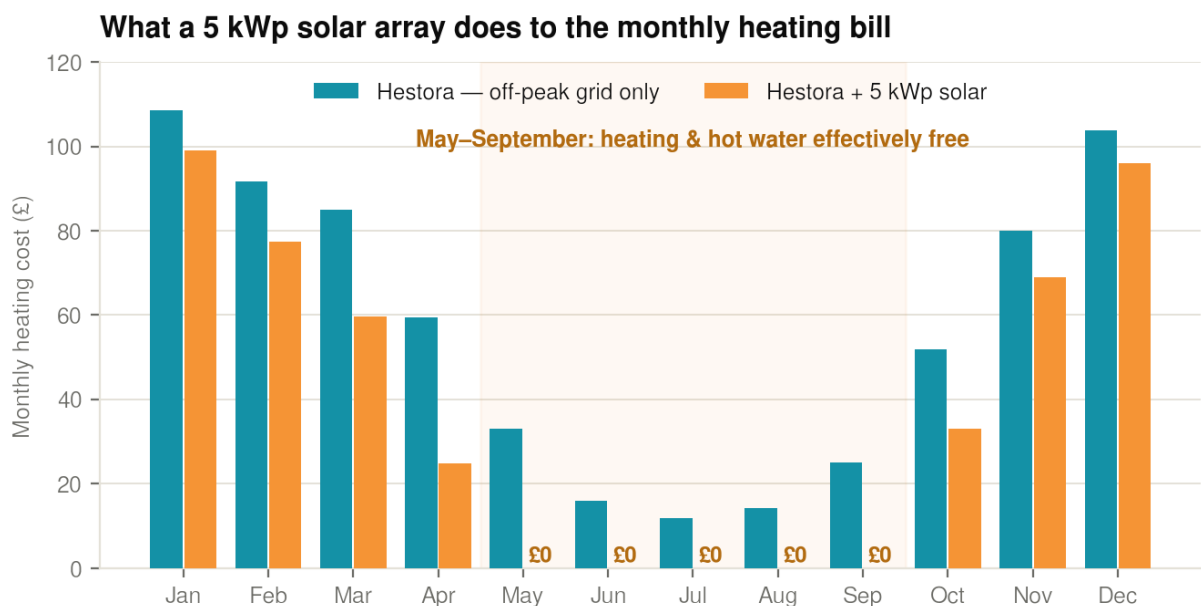
Monthly repayments on the £3,500 financed balance. The unsupported case assumes ~10% APR, consistent with mid-2026 best-buy rates for loans of this size (9.2–9.9%); Warm Homes Loan Scheme support applies the scheme's ~5-percentage-point rate cut. Over the central 7-year term the borrower saves ~£725 in interest, with nothing upfront. Thermal energy stores enter the scheme on MCS certification. Modelled on the published scheme rules; illustrative, not financial advice.

4. What it saves every year



Modelled annual cost of meeting 8,950 kWh of heat and hot-water demand, mid-2026 prices. Assumptions: direct electric at the standard single rate (24.67p/kWh) — the bill a panel- or storage-heated property pays today; gas at the current cap (7.33p/kWh plus £106/yr standing charge, 85% boiler efficiency); air-source heat pump at SCOP 3.0, spanning £631–£788 across the plausible 3.5–2.8 range; Hestora at ~7p/kWh off-peak with 92% round-trip efficiency, and with a 5 kWp array feeding the store first. Going all-electric sheds the gas standing charge; decoupling consumption from real-time prices also removes exposure to winter-evening spikes.

If the home has rooftop solar — or you add it — the numbers improve again. A built-in diverter charges the store from the roof before buying from the grid, and with a 5 kWp array that means **heating and hot water effectively free from May to September**, with April and October close behind:



Monthly heating and hot-water cost with Hestora charged from off-peak grid electricity alone (blue) and with a 5 kWp south-facing array feeding the store ahead of the grid (amber). May–September falls to zero and the annual cost drops from ~£681 to ~£459, the array supplying roughly a third of annual charging energy. Monthly-resolution model; a larger array widens the zero-cost window.

For landlords, the compliance angle

Replacing a gas boiler with an MCS-certified thermal energy store moves the property off the fossil-fuel heating that caps the EPC heating metric at band D, fits comfortably inside the £10,000 cost cap at ~£3,500 net, and — installed before October 2029 — earns up to ten years' grandparented compliance. Around a day of access, no redecoration.

5. Timing and next steps

- **Now** — register your interest at www.hestora.net to join the queue and receive updates on grant eligibility.
- **November 2026** — monitored pilot over a full winter.
- **2027** — commercial sales open, delivered through a trained installer network with an optional service subscription covering tariff optimisation, monitoring and warranty.

Hestora Limited is a British engineering company based in the Midlands, supported by energy and enterprise programmes at Imperial College London and the University of Birmingham. Questions? Contact jim@hestora.net.

This briefing summarises published scheme rules and Hestora modelling as at August 2026. Grant and loan eligibility depend on MCS certification and future policy decisions; figures are illustrative and nothing here is financial advice.